

Cohesity

AI Data Security / Data Protection · San Jose, CA · Private (Nvidia-backed; 2026 IPO, valuation benchmarked vs Rubrik)

Nvidia-backed Cohesity reached ~\$1.5B pro-forma ARR (revenue \$1.7B+) after completing its Veritas combination in Dec 2024 and is steering toward a 2026 IPO benchmarked against public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B today) - with no pure-play backup and data-resilience brand yet owning the F1 grid.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Cohesity is the rare combination our mandate prizes most: an established category leader arriving at a brand-reckoning moment with budget, motive and a clear strategic angle. After completing its combination with Veritas' data-protection business on 10 December 2024, the merged company reported pro-forma annual recurring revenue of roughly \$1.5 billion (revenue over \$1.7 billion) at a 28% adjusted cash-EBITDA margin, and the Nvidia-backed company is now steering toward a 2026 IPO with a valuation its CEO has benchmarked against publicly traded peer Rubrik (a ~\$14.5B market cap as of May 2026; the Sep-2025 CNBC report that framed the comparison cited Rubrik at ~\$17B). Two things make it a 1440 target rather than just a big company. First, it has never touched motorsport, so an approach now is early - we would not be the hundredth agency in the inbox. Second, no pure-play enterprise backup, recovery and ransomware-resilience brand yet owns a presence on the F1 grid, and the cleanest way to own it is Cadillac - the American team debuting in 2026 whose verified tech roster (IFS for ERP, TWG for AI) carries no data-protection or cybersecurity partner. As the grid's American flag-bearer, Cadillac also aligns Cohesity's brand with the US institutional investors its IPO roadshow must win. The IPO is the forcing function that turns 'someday' into 'this year'.

WHY NOW

An IPO is the single largest brand-elevation event in a company's life, and the 12 months around it are when leadership spends most deliberately on institutional credibility - exactly the currency a multi-year F1 partnership trades in. Signing around the listing lets Cohesity convert a finance milestone into a global enterprise-brand statement, pre-build the recognition that public investors reward, and secure backup-and-resilience category exclusivity before a direct rival (Rubrik, Veeam, Commvault) claims the same adjacent lane. The post-Veritas integration narrative also benefits from a single, high-visibility external proof point that the merged company is now one coherent market leader.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$1.5B

Pro-forma ARR after Veritas combination

28%

Adjusted cash-EBITDA margin

10 Dec 2024

Veritas combination completed

~\$14.5B (28 May 2026)

Rubrik market cap (IPO benchmark peer)

Carol Carpenter

CMO (decision-maker), appointed 18 Feb 2025; ex-CMO Unity & VMware

San Jose, CA

Headquarters (relocated 2025 from Santa Clara)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Cadillac

RECOMMENDED

PRIME LANE

greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero

Williams

CROWDED

data platform / storage, identity & access security

Haas

CROWDED

Mphasis, RUCKUS Networks, MoneyGram

McLaren

OPEN

no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$1.5B-ARR, 28%-margin category leader on a clear path to a 2026 IPO needs a global visibility stage now - and the one F1 entrant with an unclaimed data-resilience lane is the grid's newest brand. Move while the pre-IPO window and the greenfield team are both open.

SPINOFF UNICORN

NEVER ENTERED

FUNDING EVENT

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac is the sharpest canvas for this brand at this moment. It debuts in 2026 with a greenfield tech roster - IFS runs ERP, TWG provides AI, but no partner owns data protection, backup or cybersecurity - so Cohesity can be a FOUNDING partner and own the data-resilience category rather than share it. It compounds strategically: Cadillac is the grid's American flag-bearer and Cohesity is a US company heading into a US-market IPO, so the partnership speaks straight to the institutional investors the roadshow must win, with hospitality at the US rounds. The trade-off: a first-year team's media value is unproven - Williams is the documented fallback for a more established, data-led audience.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - a real operational fit. A brand-new team stands up its entire race and factory data estate - telemetry, simulation, design IP - from zero, and protecting and recovering it is mission-critical from day one. That is Cohesity's domain: backup, rapid recovery and ransomware resilience, complementing IFS (ERP) rather than competing. Cadillac gains real resilience and a 'we protect the data that builds a winning team' story; Cohesity gains a high-visibility American launch partner to name on the IPO roadshow.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Founding Data Resilience Partner of the Cadillac F1 Team. MINIMUM THREE YEARS - ideally four, to span the IPO and the post-listing brand-build cycle - at an estimated \$4-7M/yr (debut-team entry pricing should favour an early founding partner). Scope: garage and car branding in the backup-and-recovery category, hospitality at the US rounds targeting enterprise-IT and investor audiences, digital rights, a working data-protection deployment for the new team, and exclusivity scoped to backup/recovery/ransomware-resilience. Williams is the documented alternative if a more established, data-led audience is preferred.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Carol Carpenter
CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, COHESITY - VERIFIED VIA COHESITY NEWSROOM

Cohesity's first CMO, leading the global marketing organisation. Previously CMO at Unity and CMO at VMware (where her teams drove the multi-cloud repositioning) - a seasoned enterprise brand-builder running exactly the kind of category-defining, IPO-readiness brand programme an F1 partnership would anchor. Co-decision-makers for a spend of this size: CEO Sanjay Poonen (ex-VMware) and the IR/CFO function during the listing window.

OPENING ANGLE

"Carol, you've run the brand through a VMware-scale repositioning - you know an IPO is won on credibility, not noise. Backup and ransomware-recovery is the one enterprise-resilience lane no brand on the F1 grid has claimed. Worth 25 minutes to own it before the roadshow locks?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 Targeting a 2026 IPO - the brand-reckoning moment for a category leader. The Veritas combination completed 10 Dec 2024 brought the merged company to ~\$1.5B pro-forma ARR, and it is actively building an institutional-grade brand for the roadshow.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 Pro-forma ARR ~\$1.5B (revenue \$1.7B+) at a 28% adjusted cash-EBITDA margin, Nvidia-backed, with a 2026 IPO valuation benchmarked against public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B market cap, May 2026). Title-adjacent spend is comfortably within reach.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 Backup, recovery and ransomware resilience map cleanly to F1's data-obsessed, zero-failure engineering culture. Re-pointed to Cadillac, whose verified debut roster (IFS for ERP, TWG for AI) has no data-protection or cybersecurity partner, the category is genuinely ownable as a founding partner; tempered only by an unproven first-year team's media value.	URGENCY 15 / 20 The IPO window is a one-time elevation moment, and public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B) already raises the category's competitive temperature; a grid presence differentiates the listing.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: an F1 team generates and must protect petabytes of telemetry, simulation output and design IP - a genuine, demonstrable data-resilience use case in the garage.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO QUIET PERIOD Securities rules may restrict marketing announcements in the weeks around the listing. **Counter:** Negotiate and sign quietly, then activate post-listing; use the roadshow period to build internal consensus rather than to announce.

INTEGRATION FOCUS Post-Veritas integration may absorb leadership attention and budget. **Counter:** Position the deal as the single external proof point that the merged company is now one unified category leader - an integration accelerant, not a distraction.

SOURCES

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